

Crystal Clear · project cheat sheet

Dr WELI · Ars Biologica ArtXScience Residency 2027-28 · drweli.com/portfolio/ars-biologica/

The proposal

Applicant	Dr Weliton Menario Costa (Dr WELI). Brazilian scientist-artist, Sydney. Italian citizen, eligible to work and travel in the EU.
Title	<i>Crystal Clear</i> (working title)
Outcome	One artwork in three parts: an original pop single , a music film shot in České Budějovice with local performers, and an installation at Ars Biologica 2028. The song is released afterwards.
Science partner	Aquatic Microbial Ecology, Institute of Hydrobiology. Dr Tanja Shabarova, Dr Cecilia Chiriac, Dr Kiran Dindhorja.
Ask	€15,000 production (to the cap) + €6,000 artist fee + up to €3,000 travel

My practice

What I am	A scientist and an artist. I designed experiments, collected field data on wild kangaroos, ran the analysis and published it in <i>Behavioral Ecology</i> , then turned the same research into music, dance, performance and video.
Evidence	<i>Kangaroo Time</i> , written and directed by me. AAAS Dance Your PhD Overall Winner 2024 . 238+ media features across five continents. <i>Cabra da Peste</i> , commissioned to open the XLI Encontro Anual de Etologia. One of 30 shortlisted worldwide, Falling Walls Engage 2025.
Where it runs	Visiting Fellow, ANU Centre for the Public Awareness of Science. Studio: WildWooHoo. Genre: sci pop , defined in a citable founding paper.
Practice length	More than 5 years. Performed through the doctorate 2017-2021; a field photograph of mine is published and credited in my 2021 ANU thesis.

The artistic concept

Science speaks about reality. Art translates the emotion of that reality through the artist's angle. Reading a paper for its emotional hook means finding the opening where something in the findings opens an emotion I can enter and express what I feel in front of it. Not a point about environmental activism: an opening onto human life.

Worked example (Shabarova et al. 2021, *Nature Microbiology* 6:479). One measured quantity returned to its earlier level before the living community did. So a system can pass the check people run on it and still be short of what lived in it. *Clarity is what a person can check by looking. Recovery is not.*

□ **A demonstration of method, not a decision.** The finding is chosen with the scientists first.

How I work with the scientists, and how they are involved

Step	What happens	What they do
1	Conversation before any artistic decision. What would you most want a stranger to know?	Choose the finding with me
2	I read the chosen paper twice: for the central problem, and for the human opening	Correct anything I misread
3	I ask for existing, cleared material	Send it, see below
4	We talk through why they chose each item	One call, a sentence on each

Step	What happens	What they do
5	I write. Recordings become sound; patterns become tempo and choreography; images become film and room	Nothing
6	Three reviews: premise and demo, sources and credits, rough cut and captions	Veto over the science

What I ask them for: bioacoustic records or any sound recording from their study systems, across the different subjects and spaces; images or video showing patterns, organisation and structures of the microbiological life; and anything they find beautiful or strange in their own material. **No new field campaign.**

What I offer

Creative, science-carrying work that **opens participation at several levels at once**, which is what most people name as the measure of a successful event.

- **With the scientists:** during concept development, and in building the structure for using the material they send
- **With the community:** through dance, performance, and paid roles in the film
- **With the public:** immersion in the making, on social media and inside the installation at the festival
- **Beyond the festival:** a released pop song that keeps travelling

Activities and timeline

When	Activity	Delivered
Jan–Mar 2027 · remote	Kick-off with scientists and host; research chosen together; material request issued	Collaboration and rights framework; videos 1–3
Apr–Aug 2027 · remote	Material exchange; songwriting; 3 Sydney studio days , one spent running the concept through their recordings and patterns	Finished master and stems before filming; storyboard; videos 4–8
Sep 2027 · on site	Scientist and site meetings; public listening and movement lab; rehearsal with local movement lead; film shot with local cast	Film shot; public feedback documented; video 9
Oct 2027–Feb 2028 · remote	Edit; scientist review of facts, captions, credits; installation build and testing	Your required written phase-two proposal; final film; tested installation; videos 10–13
Mar 2028 · on site	Install, test, screen, public conversation, document, strike	Completed exhibition and film; videos 14–15

Content is an activity, not a by-product: fifteen captioned process videos, Jan 2027 to festival close, plus cleared stills to České Budějovice 2028 at each phase.

Budget

Line	€	Note
Recorded pop single, Sydney, 3 days	3,020	Forbes Street list prices
Czech music film, 2 shoot days, edit, grade	2,300	Anchored on published Czech rates
Full-run AV: screens, listening points, projection	2,100	High risk, unquoted
Czech installation designer and lead	1,600	
Movement lead + 3 paid adult performers	1,700	

Line	€	Note
Structure, surfaces, fabrication, fire treatment	800	
Fifteen process videos	700	
2027 public lab + 2028 engagement	550	
Czech language, liaison, access, subtitling	650	
Research material licences	250	
Contingency	1,330	8.9%
Total	15,000	Sums exactly to the cap

Separate: **€6,000** artist fee, **up to €3,000** travel. No supplier is commissioned and none has quoted.

Outcomes

1. An original pop single, released, that outlives the festival
2. A music film made to industry standards, with performers from the town
3. An installation at Ars Biologica 2028 showing the research, the material and the translation
4. A documented public lab (2027) and a public conversation (2028)
5. Fifteen process videos and cleared stills for the host
6. A repeatable method, tested on freshwater science and written up

Impact and risks

Risk	How it is handled
□ The first stay falls before the song exists	I request the compulsory Jan–Mar period remotely, and use the optional September stay to film. The song is mastered before I fly, so filming happens once, with the local cast and the scientists available in the same weeks. This is what makes the schedule land in time. Needs written approval.
€3,000 cannot fund three Australia–Europe crossings	The call sets travel at 2–5 Budweis trips plus 2 to Ars Electronica. From Sydney only the bottom of that range is fundable: two stays, both Linz visits by rail from Budweis inside them. Fallback: connect the first stay to an August 2027 family trip to Brazil and fly Brazil–Prague.
Full-run AV and the Czech film are unquoted	Both carry named fallbacks; both re-costed in the Oct/Nov 2027 written proposal. If AV is unaffordable: keep positioned sound and surfaces, print the process material, alternate one screen.
Scientist availability	They advise and supply existing material. Never unpaid crew, never presumed co-authors. No new field campaign.
Misrepresenting the science	Three review gates with a veto. Every source labelled with author, recordist, place and date. A recording of water is never labelled as a microorganism's voice. A forest-pond finding is never presented as a finding about a managed fishpond.
Accommodation	The call covers one month from a separate budget. Which of the two stays it applies to needs confirming.

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